

DEGREE: MSc in Artificial Intelligence

Module: Machine Learning Fundamentals

Assignment Title: Advanced Time-Series Forecasting: Comparative Analysis and Novel Machine Learning Architectures

Assignment Type: Practical Skills Assessment

Word Limit: 3000 words (+/- 300)

Weighting: 100%

Issue Date: 24/04/2026

Submission Date: 18/06/2026

Feedback Date: 02/07/2026

Issued by: Dr. Fahmid Al Farid

Plagiarism:

When submitting work for assessment, students should be aware of the InterActive/Canvas guidance and regulations in concerning plagiarism. All submissions should be your own, original work.

You must submit an electronic copy of your work. Your submission will be electronically checked.

Learner declaration		
Word count		
Use of proof-reader/proof-reading service (see guidance contained in Academic Misconduct Regulations on appropriate use)	YES	NO

If 'yes', please specify which service (e.g. Grammarly, Studiosity etc.)		
I confirm that I submit this work as my own work and that I have cited all sources I have used, and I understand that using sources without citing them correctly may be considered as Academic Misconduct.	YES	NO
I confirm that I have followed guidance on the acceptable use of AI tools for this assignment where such guidance has been issued by my tutors.	YES	NO
Where use of appropriately cited use of AI tools is permitted, I confirm that I have cited in accordance with the UCA Harvard Referencing Standard.	YES	NO

Harvard Referencing:

The Harvard Referencing System must be used. The Wikipedia, UKEssays.com or similar websites must **not** be used or referenced in your work.

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BSBI uses Turnitin (an on-line text matching tool) to help identify cases of plagiarism. Turnitin will compare a submitted assignment with a database of journal articles, books, web pages and previously submitted assignments.

Signature (Student): _____ Date: _____

Introduction

Learning Outcomes:

LO1. Choose and apply machine learning algorithms to address complex, unstructured data challenges, demonstrating creative problem-solving skills and innovation in the field.

LO2. Conduct research in machine learning, critically evaluating emerging methodologies and their implications for data-driven decision-making.

Assessment Criteria: Weighting 100%
3000 words

Tasks:

(the task is related to **LO1** and **LO2**).

Overview:

Accurate forecasting of household energy consumption is vital for enhancing smart-grid efficiency, enabling sustainable energy planning, and supporting informed decision-making at the consumer level. Traditional analytical methods often fall short in capturing the complex temporal patterns and nonlinear relationships present in real-world energy-consumption data. In contrast, machine learning and deep learning approaches provide powerful tools for modeling these intricate dynamics with higher accuracy.

In this assignment, students are required to implement a complete time-series forecasting pipeline using historical household energy-consumption data. The task involves data preprocessing, exploratory time-series analysis, feature engineering, model development, and performance evaluation. The primary objective is to design and develop an effective forecasting model capable of predicting short-term and/or long-term household energy demand.

Abstract

Provide a concise summary of the project, clearly stating the objective of forecasting household energy consumption.

Briefly describe the dataset utilized, the machine learning or deep learning techniques applied, and highlight the key results or outcomes achieved through the study.

1. Introduction

- Introduce the importance of energy-consumption forecasting for smart-grid management and sustainability.
- Explain the limitations of traditional forecasting methods and how machine learning can address these challenges.
- Clearly state the project objective: developing a predictive model using historical time-series data.

2. Literature Review

- Summarize key existing approaches to energy-demand forecasting, including classical time-series models, machine learning techniques, and deep learning methods.
- Highlight major findings and limitations in current research that your project aims to address.

3. Data Collection:

- Choose a publicly available, gold-standard time-series dataset for household energy consumption. The recommended dataset is the "Individual household electric power consumption Data Set" available from the UCI Machine Learning Repository, which can also be accessed on Kaggle:
- <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/uciml/electric-powerconsumption-data-set>.
- Select and load the dataset containing the time-series data.

4. Data Preprocessing:

- Clean the data by handling missing values and any duplicates. This dataset is known to have missing values that require a robust strategy.
- Convert the data into a format suitable for time-series analysis. This will likely involve parsing date-time columns and setting a time-based index.
- Resample the data to a more appropriate frequency (e.g., from minute-level to hourly or daily averages) to make computation manageable and to smooth out noise. Justify your choice of frequency.
- Perform feature engineering by creating new time-based features (e.g., hour of the day, day of the week, month) that might help the model learn patterns.

5. Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA):

- Conduct an exploratory analysis of the resampled data.
- Use visualizations (e.g., line plots, box plots) to identify trends, seasonality, and other patterns in energy consumption over time.
- Provide basic statistics about the dataset, such as summary statistics and information about the columns.

6. Model Selection and Design:

- Split the preprocessed time-series dataset into training and testing sets. Ensure the split is done chronologically to respect the temporal nature of the data.

- Propose and provide brief details for at least three existing machine learning algorithms suitable for time-series forecasting. Consider a mix of classical statistical models and modern machine learning regression models.
- Justify your choice of algorithms and provide the working principle for each.

7. Code Implementation:

- Write a Python script that develops a forecasting model for household energy consumption using the selected ML algorithms.
- Integrate Python code snippets, visualizations, and pertinent documentation seamlessly into the analysis to clarify how the models were implemented.

8. Model Evaluation:

- Evaluate your models using appropriate regression metrics such as **Mean Absolute Error (MAE)**, **Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE)**, and **R-squared (R^2)**.
- Visualize the performance by plotting the predicted values against the actual values for the test set.
- Compare the machine learning techniques used for this task, emphasizing the model that performed the best and outlining the factors that contributed to its success.

9. Conclusion:

- Summarize the findings and outcomes of the project.
- Suggest potential future improvements or use cases for the methodology. Highlight areas for further development, such as incorporating external data (e.g., weather) or using more advanced deep learning models.

Submission Instructions:

- Create a practical analysis within the designated word limit (3000 words).
- Maintain clarity, organization, and logical flow when presenting your result analysis.
- Utilize the BSBI assignment template provided on Canvas for document preparation.
- Employ the Harvard referencing style for your bibliography.
- Refer to the Essay Guide on Canvas for additional instructions.
- Submit your assignment electronically by the stipulated deadline.

Students are encouraged to explore additional reputable sources in the digital library beyond the list provided to strengthen their individual research and critical analysis skills. The unit lecturer can help with recommending additional literature.

The criteria for successfully passing the units with two assessment components require passing both components successfully. Passing marks for BSc and MA/MSc levels are different and are stated at the end of the assignment brief. Please find the examples below:

- **Example 1** (e.g., pass mark: 50)
- Component 1 (50% weighting) - 55

- Component 2 (50% weighting) - 55
 - Final average: 55
 - Result: **Pass (both components passed and therefore the unit is passed)**
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- **Example 2** (e.g., pass mark: 50)
 - Component 1 (50% weighting) – 80
 - Component 2 (50% weighting) – 30
 - Final average: 55
 - Result: **Fail (because although the average is above 50, one of the components is a failure)**

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

EXPERIMENTATION & INNOVATION								
	FAIL			PASS				
Threshold Criteria	0-29%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-89%	90-100%
Deals with complex issues both systematically and creatively demonstrating self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems	Little to no ability to use techniques to deal with complex issues systematically (including those of ethics and sustainability) and creatively to solve problems and/or make decisions.	Low utilisation of established techniques to deal with complex issues systematically (including those of ethics and sustainability) and creatively to solve problems and/or make decisions, but with limitations in techniques or approach.	Limited research or advanced scholarship to their area of study by using a range of information and established and advanced techniques	Competent understanding of solving problems, through own research or advanced scholarship displaying a comprehensive understanding of established and advanced techniques	Good understanding of solving problems through own research and advanced scholarship critically selecting and displaying a comprehensive understanding of established and advanced techniques.	Very Good problem-solving skills displaying a comprehensive understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship	Excellent range of extremely well-developed problem-solving displaying an understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship beyond which is taught.	Exceptional problem-solving skills with sophisticated evaluation and application of a wide range of advanced information and techniques to undertake projects.
Comprehensive understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship	Little to no understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship or their limitations and ambiguities.	Low understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship including their limitations and ambiguities.	Limited understanding of key techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship including their limitations and ambiguities.	Competent understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship including their limitations and ambiguities	Good understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship and a some understanding of more specialised techniques.	Very good understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship and a some understanding of more specialised techniques.	Excellent understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship and mastery of some more specialised areas.	Exceptional understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship and mastery of some more specialised areas.

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS								
	FAIL			PASS				
Threshold Criteria	0-29%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-89%	90-100%
Systematic understanding of knowledge, and a critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, much of which is at, or informed by, the forefront of their academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice	Little to no knowledge of the subject with limited breadth or depth or deficiencies in major areas or currency.	Low knowledge of the subject lacking coherence, breadth, or detail with only some reference to ideas or arguments at the forefront of any part of the subject.	Limited knowledge to deal with terminology, facts and concepts some of which is informed by the forefront of defined areas of the subject.	Competent knowledge of ideas or arguments at the forefront of any part of the subject sufficient to deal with current issues in the discipline, generally more descriptive than critical or analytical.	Good knowledge of ideas or arguments at the forefront of any part of the subject showing a clear, critical insight into the discipline as whole and current issues/problems.	Very good knowledge of ideas or arguments at the forefront of the subject some of which are significantly beyond what has been taught and show a critical insight into the discipline and current issues/problems.	Excellent knowledge of ideas or arguments at the forefront of the subject many of which are significantly beyond what has been taught and show a critical insight into the discipline and current issues/problems.	Exceptional knowledge of ideas or arguments at the forefront of the subject most of which are significantly beyond what has been taught and show a critical insight into the discipline and current issues/problems.
Conceptual understanding that enables the student to display originality in the application of knowledge	Little to no conceptual understanding or argument and a focus on descriptive explanations which do not comment on arguments of others or alternative views.	Low conceptual understanding and arguments are weak or poorly constructed, and the work does not critically evaluate the arguments of others or consider alternative views.	Limited conceptual understanding and argument construction with critical evaluation of alternative views or comment on advanced scholarship.	Competent conceptual understanding and argument construction with critical evaluation of a range of views and consistent engagement with advanced scholarship.	Good conceptual understanding which critically evaluate and synthesise other views and information with a thoughtful interpretation of advanced scholarship.	Very good conceptual understanding which systematically synthesises a wide range of views with a critical insight into advanced scholarship.	Excellent conceptual understanding which critically apply a wide range of views through a perceptive use of advanced scholarship.	Exceptional conceptual understanding of publishable quality with systematic engagement and usage of advanced scholarship.

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

ENGAGING WITH PRACTICE								
	FAIL			PASS				
Threshold Criteria	0-29%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-89%	90-100%
Practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the discipline	Little to no evidence of background investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study.	Low evidence of background investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study.	Limited background investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study using established techniques, with the ability to extract relevant points.	Competent investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study using established techniques accurately, and can critically appraise and use academic sources.	Good background investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study using established techniques accurately, and possesses a well-developed ability to critically appraise a wide range of sources.	Very good, independent, extensive and appropriate investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study beyond the usual range, and critically evaluates this to advance the work and/or direct arguments.	Excellent independent, extensive and appropriate investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study well beyond the usual range, and critically evaluates this to advance the work and/or direct arguments.	Exceptional investigation, analysis, research, enquiry, ethical awareness, and/or study which demonstrates carefully considered depth and breadth and critically synthesises this to advance the work and/or direct arguments.
Originality in the application of knowledge	Little to no technical, creative or artistic skills related to their area of study.	Low technical, creative or artistic skills related to their area of study.	Limited technical, creative or artistic skills required for area of study.	Competent technical, creative or artistic skills required for area of study.	Good technical, creative or artistic skills required for area of study.	Very good range of technical, creative or artistic skills.	Excellent range of technical, creative or artistic skills	Exceptional range of technical, creative or artistic skills
Independently advance your own knowledge and understanding, and to develop new skills to a high level.	Little to no contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Low contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Limited contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Competent contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level.	Good contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with an understanding of team roles	Very good contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with an understanding of team roles	Excellent contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with teamwork and leadership	Exceptional contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with teamwork and strong leadership.

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

REALISATION & COMMUNICATION								
	FAIL			PASS				
Threshold Criteria	0-29%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-89%	90-100%
Communicate information, ideas, problems and solutions to both specialist and non-specialist audiences.	Little to no clarity in the communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences.	Low clarity in the communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences.	Limited clarity in the communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences.	Competent communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences.	Good, confident and clear communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences in a range of means / media.	Very good, confident and clear communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences in a range of means / media.	Excellent communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences in a range of means / media.	Exceptional communication of ideas, problems and solutions to audiences in a range of means / media.

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

PERSONAL & PROFESSIONAL CONNECTIVITY								
	FAIL			PASS				
Threshold Criteria	0-29%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-89%	90-100%
Independently advance your own knowledge and understanding, and develop new skills to a high level.	Little to no contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Low contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Limited contribution to group activity and/or undertaking further training at a high/advanced level.	Competent contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level.	Good contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with an understanding of team roles	Very good contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with an understanding of team roles	Excellent contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with teamwork and leadership	Exceptional contribution to group activity and/or independently undertakes further training at a high/advanced level with teamwork and strong leadership.
Qualities and transferable skills necessary for employment requiring: (a) the exercise of initiative, ethical and personal responsibility (b) decision-making in complex and unpredictable contexts	Little to no ability to manage learning and/or exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility and/or decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Low ability to manage learning and/or exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility and/or decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Limited ability to manage learning and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Competent ability to manage learning, and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Good ability to systematically manage learning, and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Very good ability to systematically manage learning, and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations.	Excellent ability to manage learning on own initiative, and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations	Exceptional ability to manage learning on own initiative, and exercise initiative, ethical and personal responsibility, and decision-making in complex and unpredictable situations
	Little to no use of appropriate terminology, limited vocabulary and many errors in spelling, grammar and syntax.	Low use of appropriate terminology, with many errors in spelling, vocabulary and syntax.	Limited expression, style and appropriate vocabulary with errors in spelling, grammar and syntax which affect understanding.	Competent expression, style, and appropriate vocabulary with some errors in spelling, grammar and syntax which do not affect understanding.	Good expression, style and appropriate vocabulary with some errors in spelling, grammar and syntax.	Very good expression, style and appropriate vocabulary with minimal errors in spelling, grammar and syntax.	Excellent expression, style and appropriate vocabulary with minimal errors in spelling, grammar and syntax.	Exceptional expression, style and appropriate vocabulary with no errors in spelling, grammar and syntax.

GRADING DESCRIPTORS: LEVEL 7

	Little to no evidence of basic numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills	Low evidence of basic numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.	Limited evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.	Adequate evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.	Good evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.	Very good evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills	Excellent evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.	Exceptional evidence of numeracy or digital literacy, hardware and software skills competency.
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	competency.					competency.		
	Does not demonstrate achievement of professional competence when assessed against the requirements of a professional, statutory or regulatory body (PSRB).			The student has demonstrated achievement of professional competence when assessed against the requirements of a PSRB.				
	Inaccurate use of terminology with limited vocabulary and many errors in spelling, grammar and syntax. Inaccurate terminology, with many errors in spelling, vocabulary and syntax.			The student has adhered to the appropriate rules and/or conventions set by regulators or the industry.				